

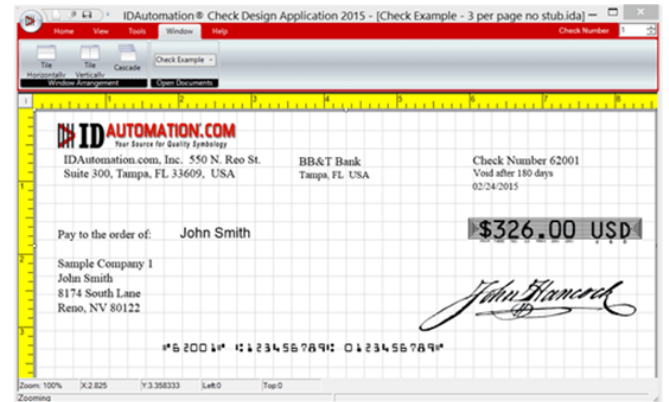
MICR Check Printing Design Software User Guide

IDAutomation Check Printing and Design Software allows users to easily design, create, and print bank checks onto blank or pre-designed check stock. This product is free to use when purchasing the MICR E-13B Font Advantage Package.

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Check Printing Design Software Installation

This Bank Check Printing Design Software is compatible with Windows 7 and above.

1. Purchase and install the required MICR E-13B Font Package or download the MICR demo first for testing.
2. Download the Check Design Application and open the file named IDAutomation_MICR_Check_Design_Application.exe.
3. If it is desired to have the software generate MICR without a font installed, the IDAutomation Label Software Pro version should be used. It can print MICR from a component without requiring the installation of fonts.

Bank Check Creation and Design

Referred to as "labels" in the software, bank checks can be created to include MICR characters, text, and graphics. Labels, such as templates, may also be saved and retrieved for later use. Sample label files are provided in the software download and can be accessed from:

Start - Programs - IDAutomation MICR Check Design Application - Check Examples.

1. After the application is installed, open the software from the appropriate program group or icon and select *Create New Check*.
2. In the *Check Options* screen, choose the printer where the checks will be printed, the check stock type, and the preferred unit of measurement. Two predefined check stock types are available: 3 per page business size, with or without a .5" perforation at the bottom. If these predefined labels are not compatible with the selected printer or if another type of check stock is required, select the *Define Custom Check Stock* option and click *Next*.

Check Options
Select Printer, Check Stock Type, and desired units

Printer Selection

Microsoft XPS Document Writer

Label Stock Type

☒ Define Custom Check Stock
☐ Pick Predefined Check Stock

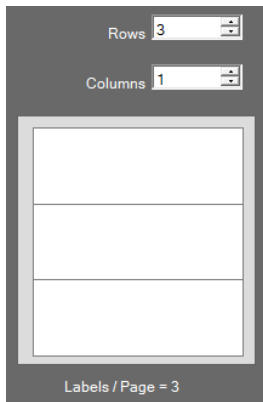
Preferred Units

☒ Inches
☐ Centimeters

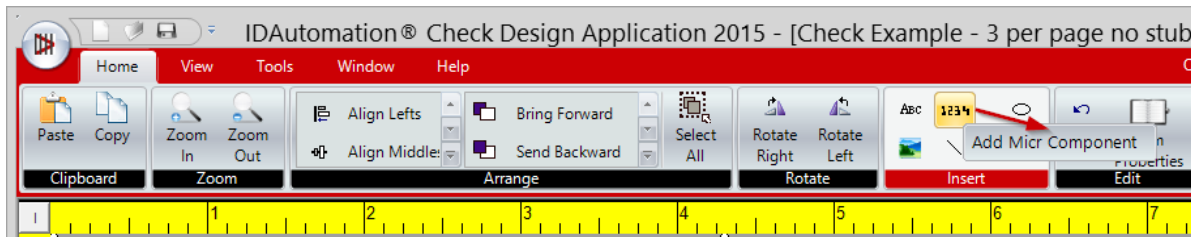
Next

Cancel

3. The following screen allows for the automatic calculation of each label's size. Most check stock is 3 checks per page, which is 3 rows and 1 column. If there is a perforation on the bottom of the check stock, enter a bottom margin of .5 inches. Select the number of rows and columns of the label sheet and click **OK**.



4. On the next screen, click the appropriate toolbar icon to add text, MICR, and graphic objects into the white design area. A gray border in the design area indicates an area where the selected printer is not able to print.



5. Any object property may be modified by right-clicking the object and selecting properties.
6. From the properties window of the MICR object, select the *Value* tab. This determines the value to encode in the MICR line. The best method of creating the MICR line is with a VB script formula. The formula will need to assemble the MICR line according to the associated characters:

Letter to Type: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 A B C D
 MICR Output: ⑆ 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 ⑆ ⑆ ⑆ ⑆ ⑆ ⑆

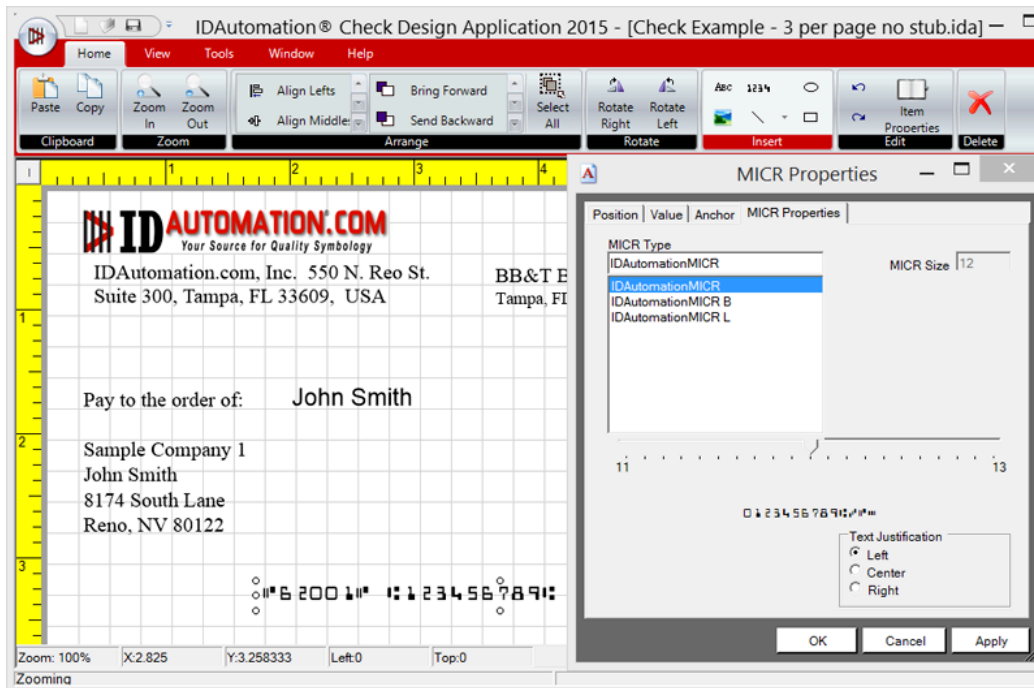
For example, the following formula value creates a MICR line for a preprinted business-size bank check:

"C" & LabelField(SerialNumber) & "C A763591681A 0710527197C"

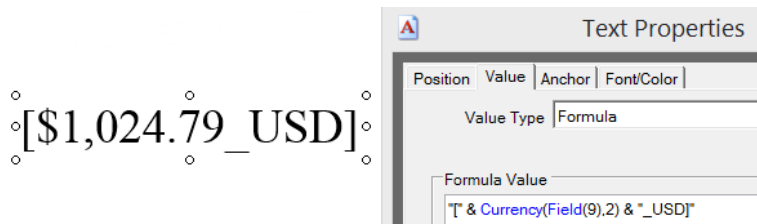
When the serial number check field is set to 621001, the following result is produced for check number one:

⑆ ⑆ 2 1 0 0 1 ⑆ ⑆ 7 6 3 5 9 1 6 8 1 A ⑆ ⑆ 0 7 1 0 5 2 7 1 9 7 ⑆ ⑆

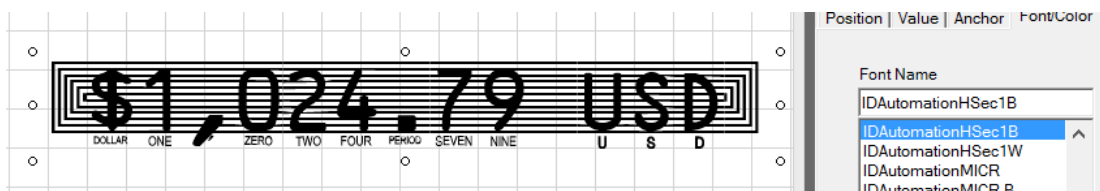
7. Select **Start - Programs - IDAutomation MICR Font Advantage - MICR Setup - Calibration Tool**. Print one page with the printer, toner, and check stock that will be used to print bank checks to verify proper MICR calibration. If calibration is necessary, select the appropriately sized font in the *MICR Properties* tab. Alternatively, the point size of the font may also be increased or decreased instead of calibration.



8. In the bank check design process, it is highly recommended that security fonts be used for the amount field with a formula in a text object. When these are used, it is no longer necessary to print the written check amounts. For example, the formula "[& Currency(Field(9),2) & "_USD"]" converts field 9 of a data source to the format necessary for the security fonts.



Security fonts are included with the IDAutomation MICR Font Advantage license.



9. Additional resources are available to assist in designing MICR checks, such as the official ANSI X9.100 document. When the check design is complete, select the **Print** or **Print Preview** icon.
10. Confirm the print range and select **Print**. Consider first printing only a few checks to verify that the printer is correctly aligned. If the checks do not print accurately, select **Application Button - Check Layout** and confirm that all margins are set to 0. If there is a perforation on the bottom of the check stock, enter a bottom margin, which is the size of the perforation, usually .5 inches.

Check Stock Definition

Define the check stock you plan to use

Label Name
Custom Label Definition

Paper Type
Letter

Width 8.5 inch Height 11 inch

Label Size
☒ Calculate Automatically
Width 8.5 inch Height 3.5 inch

Spacing Between Labels
Horizontal 0 inch Vertical 0 inch

Margins
Left 0 inch Top 0 inch
Right 0 inch Bottom 5 inch

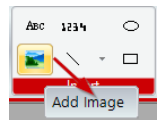
Rows 3
Columns 1

Labels / Page = 3

Save OK Cancel

Adding Signature Images

Signature images may be added to a check design by selecting the *Add Image* icon. If there is no authorized signature image, one may be created by scanning the signature on a document or by taking a clear picture of the image with a camera. After the image is saved to the computer, crop the signature portion out of the image and save it as a separate file. Windows provides a snipping tool that makes this process very simple. The signature image should have a completely white or transparent background.



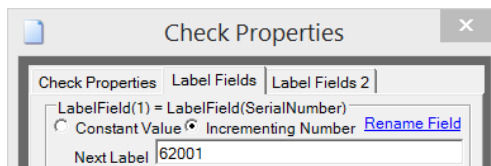
Creating Incrementally-Numbered Check Label Fields

Label fields may be used to track check numbers or simplify updates when multiple objects on a check use the same information. For example, a text object and a MICR object may contain the same serial number field that keeps track of the check number.

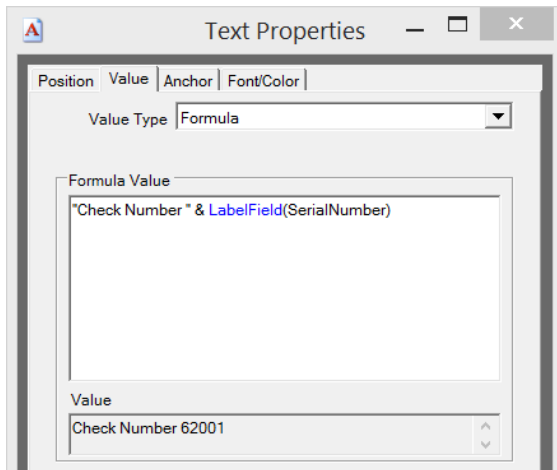
Label Fields may be constant values or incrementing numbers, the *latter* of which keeps track of numbers that have been printed in previous print jobs, so that each check is associated with a unique number. When the check is next opened for printing, the serial number fields begin incrementing at the next unused number.

Steps to Set up Label Fields:

1. With the check label open, select *Edit - Properties* in Classic Mode or select *Item Properties* off the Home Tab in Advanced Mode.
2. Select the *Label Fields* tab.



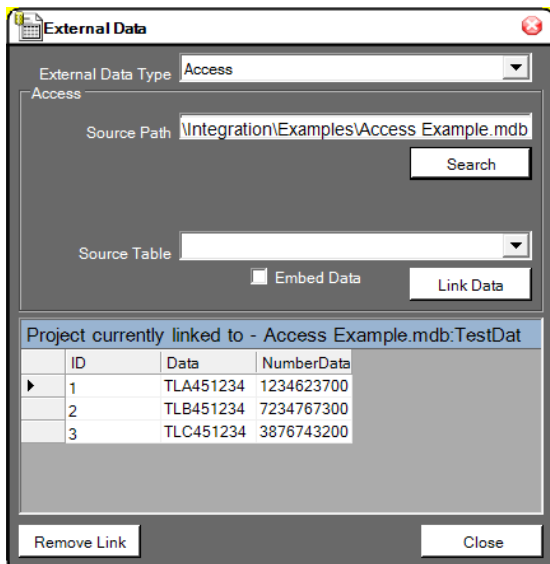
3. Select *Constant Value* or *Incrementing Number* and enter any necessary values or numbers. Choose the *Rename Field* option to create a friendly name for the field.
4. After the fields are created and applied, they may be used in the *Value* tab with a VB Script formula.
5. If resetting *SerialNumber* fields to a different value, open the *Label Fields* tab and set the value.



Link to an External Data Source or Database

The Check Design Printing software can link to columns in Microsoft Access, Excel, or a CSV text file as a data source for a text or MICR object. This allows the printing of labels from data that exists in Excel and Access, or a file export from other applications. Perform the following to link to an external data source:

1. Select *Tools - Data Sets - Link - External Data*.
2. Choose the external data type and then *Search* to find the file.
3. After the source path is located, choose the appropriate source sheet if applicable.
4. Select *Embed Data* to see a snippet of the linked data.
5. After the data is linked, select *Close*.
6. To link an entire column of data to a MICR or text object, click the down arrow next to *Value Type* and select *External DataSource*, then click the source column to link the value. The example window will display what is linked.



7. Increment the *Label Number* in the design screen to verify that the data is linked.
8. When printing, consider selecting the "all rows data source" as the option, but only after printing a single page to verify accurate alignment.
9. When linking to CSV or text files, the format should be as follows:
"Column1", "Column2", "Column3"

Create an Embedded DataSet

IDAutomation Check Design and Printing Software allows a user to create a database, which is embedded in the label data file itself. This allows data entry of several different custom values to be created on labels.

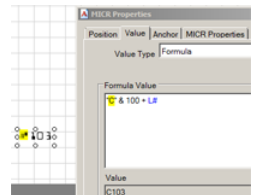
1. Select *Tools - Data Sets - Create Embedded DataSet*.
2. By default, three columns are created. Use the buttons at the bottom of the window to add, remove, or export the data.

- ## Adjusting MICR or Text Object Properties

NOTE: The Barcode Label Pro version includes additional VB script formulas in addition to barcode capability and a MICR component that does not rely on the MICR font to be installed.

- 11 6 2 1 0 0 1 1 1 7 6 3 5 9 1 6 8 1 1 0 7 1 0 5 2 7 1 9 7 1 1

- Letter to Type: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 A B C D
MICR Output: 0 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13



- ## Support

- Troubleshooting MICR Font and Component Issues
- Order MICR Toner and Check Stock

- General Barcode Font Support Issues
- Contact Technical Support

Popular Forum Post Resolutions:

- InvalidOperationException after installing (*Disable and re-enable .NET 3.5*)
- Anchors are offset from objects
- Using MICR Fonts in Crystal Reports
- How to install MICR Fonts on Windows
- MICR E13B Special Characters
- Printing issues with MICR Font

The source for the IDAutomation Check Printing and Design Software can be obtained with the purchase of the Unlimited Developer License for the MICR E-13B Font Package and a signed Source Code Agreement.

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